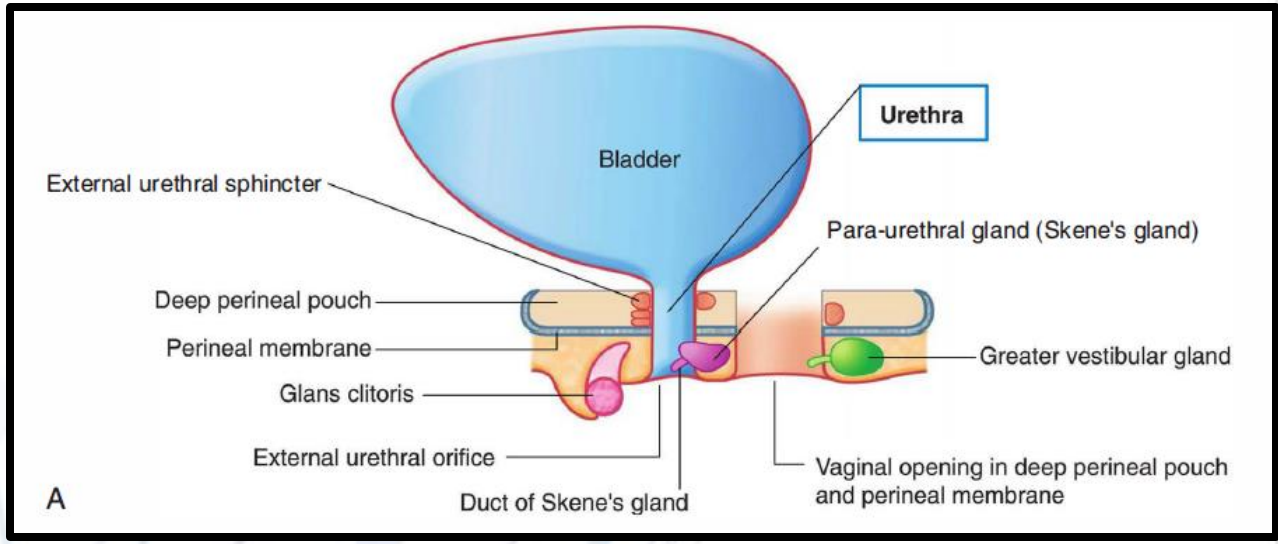
Female Urethra

- The female urethra is about 4 cm long. It extends from the neck of the bladder to the external meatus, where it opens into the vestibule of the vagina. It passes through perineal pouch and is surrounded by the sphincter urethrae. It lies in front of the vagina.

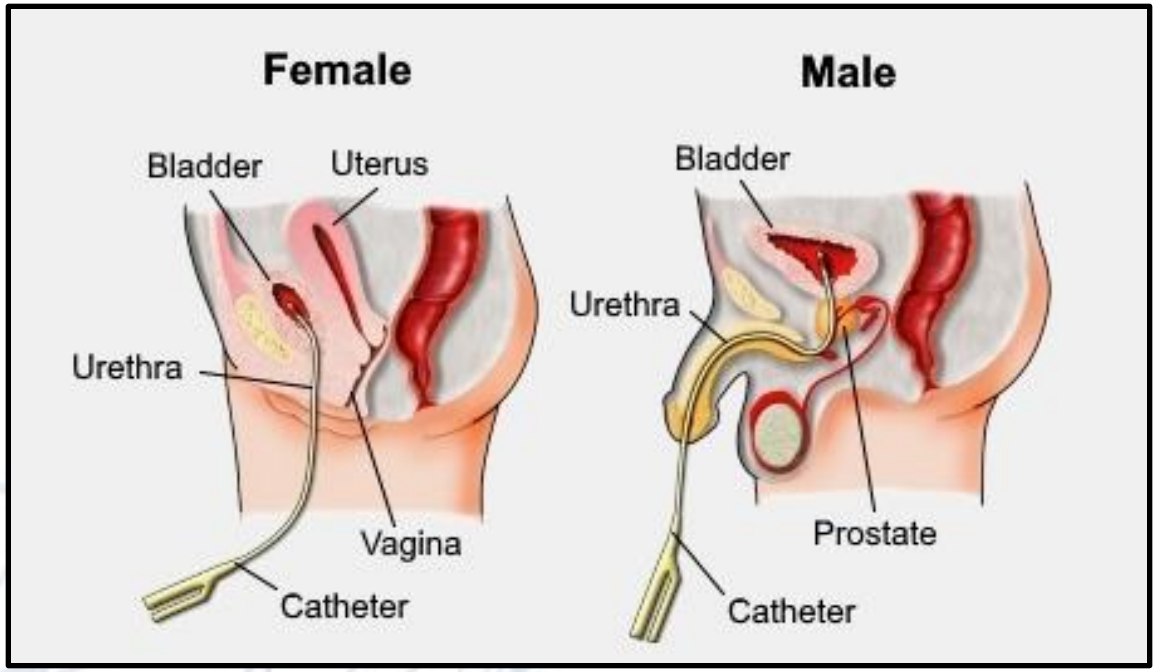


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Applied anatomy

Catheterization:

Because the female urethra is shorter, wider, and more dilatable, catheterization is much easier than in males. Moreover, the urethra is straight, and only minor resistance is felt as the catheter passes through the urethral sphincter.



Urethral Infection:

The short length of the female urethra predisposes to ascending infection; consequently, cystitis is more common in females than in males.

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Test Your Self

Regarding the relation of the urinary bladder, the following statements are true except:

A. Its base is related to the cervix of the uterus and anterior wall of the vagina in females.

B. Its superior surface is related to the rectum in males.

C. Its superior surface is related to the anterior surface of the uterus and uterovesical pouch in females.

D. Its inferolateral surface is related to the obturator internus and levator ani on each side.

Test Your Self

Regarding the relation of the urinary bladder, the following statements are true except:

A. Its base is related to the cervix of the uterus and anterior wall of the vagina in females.
B. Its superior surface is related to the rectum in males.
C. Its superior surface is related to the anterior surface of the uterus and uterovesical pouch in females.
D. Its inferolateral surface is related to the obturator internus and levator ani on each side.

- Answer: B

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Test Your Self

Regarding the male urethra, the following statements are true except:

A. The prostatic urethra is the narrowest and least dilatable part of the urethra.

B. The mucosa on the posterior wall of the prostatic urethra presents a median ridge known as the urethral crest.

C. The membranous urethra traverses the deep perineal pouch.

D. The spongy urethra presents a dilation near its termination known as fossa navicularis.

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- Answer: A

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